

Unit 4: Research, understanding and written response

IA2 compulsory unit

Externally assessed

4.1 Unit content

In this unit, students will develop their listening, reading and writing skills in Spanish.

They will develop their ability to listen and respond in Spanish, while learning about the seven general topic areas (GTAs):

- Youth matters
- Lifestyle, health and fitness
- Environment and travel
- Education and employment
- Technology in the Spanish-speaking world
- Society in the Spanish-speaking world
- Ethics in the Spanish-speaking world.

Students will also develop their ability to write in Spanish by studying **one** from a prescribed set of topics, literary texts and films in Spanish:

- Geography topic
- History topic
- Literary texts (literature)
- Films.

The grammar list provided in *Appendix 6* illustrates the level required for this qualification.

What students need to learn

Students will learn to recognise and use the Spanish language in a variety of contexts and in relation to a prescribed range of general topic areas (GTAs). The unit draws upon seven GTAs and a prescribed set of topics, literary texts and films:

General topic areas (GTAs)

Subtopics

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 Youth matters | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Family relationships and friendships• Peer pressure and role models• Music and fashion• Technology and communication |
| 2 Lifestyle, health and fitness | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Food and diet• Sport and exercise• Health issues• Urban and rural life |
| 3 Environment and travel | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Tourism, travel and transport• Natural disasters and weather• Climate change and its impact• Energy, pollution and recycling |
| 4 Education and employment | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Education systems and types of schooling• Pupil/student life• Volunteering and internships• Jobs and unemployment |
| 5 Technology in the Spanish-speaking world | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Scientific advances• Technological innovations• Impact on life and environment |
| 6 Society in the Spanish-speaking world | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Migration• Equality• Politics• Customs |

General topic areas (GTAs)

Subtopics

7 Ethics in the Spanish-speaking world

- Beliefs
- Law and order
- Moral issues (e.g. euthanasia, adoption, genetic modification)

Set topics, literary texts and films

1 Geography topic

Students would be expected to undertake wide research, become aware of and demonstrate understanding of the following:

- key people, events and issues (e.g. demographic, environmental, economic, social, political) that have impacted or are having an impact on the area in a Spanish-speaking country, region or community
- customs, traditions, beliefs and religions.

The area chosen **must** be in a Spanish-speaking country, region or community.

2 History topic

Students would be expected to undertake wide research, consider and demonstrate understanding of the following:

- a specific period of history of particular relevance to a Spanish-speaking country, key people, events and issues from the above period.

The period of history chosen **must** relate to a Spanish-speaking country, region or community.

3 Literary texts (literature)

- Esquivel: *Como agua para chocolate*
- Delibes: *El príncipe destronado*
- Isabel Allende: *Inés del alma mía*
- Fernando Fernán-Gómez: *Las bicicletas son para el verano*
- Federico Garcia Lorca: *Yerma*

4 Films

- Guillermo del Toro: *El laberinto del fauno*
- Emilio Martínez-Lázaro: *Ocho apellidos vascos*
- Andrés Wood: *Machuca*
- Joshua Marston: *Maria, llena eres de gracia*
- Icíar Bollaín: *También la lluvia*